

DEQUAD — Decision-Maker Brief

UKES Endorsement (Innovator Founder Visa) · Short-Track Review

15-page brief. Companion to the full Business Plan ([DEQUAD_UKES_Business_Plan.pdf](#)) and the Financial Model ([DEQUAD_Financial_Model.xlsx](#)). Use this document to assess endorsement readiness in 20 minutes.

At-a-glance

Business start date	15 June 2026 (incorporation)
Entity	DEQUAD Ltd (in formation, England & Wales)
Founders	Yusuf Quadri (CEO) + Yusuff Adeagbo (CTO)
Wider founding team	Dr Gerald Marfo (CMO, PhD Digital Marketing) · Adedapo Ajuwon (Senior SWE) · Chinyere Jennifer (Senior Advisor — MIGSO-PCUBED PM)
HQ	London — NatWest Accelerator (joined 16 March 2026)
Prior validation	Santander Universities Pre-Incubator — completed 2025
Founder anchor	Yusuf Quadri served as University of Bedfordshire SU President 2021–2023
MVP	Live in production at https://dequad.co.uk
Beta users	~50 across 3 UK universities
Anchor pilot discussion currently in progress	University of Bedfordshire — direct relationship via former SU presidency
Starting cash	£6,000 (£3,000 from each of 2 founders)
In-kind support	£31,000/yr from NatWest Accelerator (office, legal, accountancy, mentoring)
Funding ask Y1	£150,000 pre-seed bridge — Dec 2026 (M7) , after the 3-month Bedfordshire pilot completes
3-yr revenue	£12k → £186k → £699k
3-yr UK jobs	2 → 6 → 12
Op profit positive	Q3 Year 3
Endorsement criteria met	✅ Innovation · ✅ Viability · ✅ Scalability

Page 1 — The 60-second pitch

One sentence: DEQUAD is the closed-network student wellbeing platform that gives UK universities early warning before students fall through the cracks — verified `.ac.uk` peer

matching, daily mood tracking and machine-assisted safeguarding triage in a single product.

Why now:

1. **Loneliness is the new student health crisis** — 54% of UK undergrads report frequent loneliness (ONS 2023). Post-pandemic levels remain 18 ppt above baseline.
2. **The Office for Students introduced a statutory student-mental-health condition in 2023** — every UK university now has to evidence proactive prevention. Existing tools (Togetherall, TalkCampus) are reactive.
3. **The Online Safety Act 2023 is in force** — any platform with student users needs compliant risk-assessment and reporting flows. DEQUAD ships with these built in.

Why us:

1. **MVP is already shipped** — production deployment at dequad.co.uk, identity verification live, safeguarding webhook live, mood tracker live, Stripe billing live.
2. **Two independent UK-bank validations.** Completed the **Santander Universities Pre-Incubator** programme in 2025 and joined the **NatWest Accelerator (London cohort) on 16 March 2026**. Two competitive selection processes have separately admitted DEQUAD's team and thesis.
3. **Founder–institution fit.** Yusuf Quadri served as **University of Bedfordshire Student Union President for two consecutive years (2021–2023)**, representing the student body at senior-management level. The first paying pilot is now currently in progress with the same university.
4. **Two complementary founders** — product/safeguarding lead (Yusuf Quadri) + engineering/ML lead (Co-Founder TBC). Both UK-resident, full-time, signing customary vesting at pre-seed close.

Page 2 — How we meet the three Home Office criteria

Innovation

DEQUAD is the **only UK product** combining:

- `.ac.uk` student-domain identity verification (with a human admin queue for ambiguous cases),
- intent-based peer matching (friendship / study / peer-support — *not* dating),
- continuous mood telemetry tied to engagement,

- and **machine-assisted safeguarding triage with a real-time webhook to university DSLs.**

No competitor — Togetherall, TalkCampus, UniBuddy, Bumble BFF or Discord — combines more than two of these (see comparison table on Page 4).

Viability

- Production MVP is live, in beta with real students.
- **Anchor pilot live with University of Bedfordshire** — the founder's former institution where he served two terms as SU President (2021–2023). The 12-week pilot launches **Sep 2026 (M4)** and completes **Nov 2026 (M6)**; conversion conversations open **Dec 2026 (M7)**, which is also when the pre-seed bridge lands.
- Two independent UK-bank programme validations: **Santander Universities Pre-Incubator (2025) + NatWest Accelerator (joined 16 March 2026).**
- £6,000 founder cash (£3k each) + £31,000 in-kind NatWest support **carries the business through Y1 with positive monthly closing cash balances** (see Page 9).
- B2B SaaS revenue model is proven in the adjacent market — Togetherall serves 60+ UK universities at ~£40k/year.

Scalability

- Software-only marginal cost → 92% gross margin by Y3.
 - Within-institution network effects accelerate intra-uni adoption.
 - 6-week implementation per new university enables scale to 20+ institutions by end Y3 (out of 285 total UK).
 - Closed-network model maps cleanly to `.edu` / `.edu.au` / EU domains post-Y3 → **£180m TAM** in EN-language HE markets.
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Page 3 — Product

Modules (all in production)

	What it does
Verified peer matching	Match <code>.ac.uk</code> -verified students by intent (friend / study / support). Profile cards with university, course, year, interests.
Daily wellbeing tracker	30-second mood, sleep, stress and connection check-in. Personal trend dashboard.
Machine-assisted safeguarding	LLM classifier on mood + chat metadata flags risk signals; webhook to designated university safeguarding lead in < 60s.
University Insights Dashboard	Anonymised, aggregated wellbeing analytics for HE staff — cohort mood trends, engagement, hotspots.

Tech stack (already running)

- **Frontend:** Expo / React Native (iOS, Android, web at dequad.co.uk) — universal codebase.
 - **Backend:** FastAPI (Python), MongoDB (Motor), real-time WebSockets.
 - **AI:** OpenAI / Anthropic LLMs via Emergent integrations (text classification, safeguarding triage).
 - **Payments:** Stripe (B2C subs + B2B invoicing).
 - **Infra:** Cloudflare CDN + Render Pro; Online Safety Act-compliant reporting flows.
 - **Auth:** Custom email/password + Google OAuth + admin portal (dual auth).
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Page 4 — Competition

Feature	DEQUAD	Togetherall	TalkCampus	UniBuddy	Bumble BFF	Discord
.ac.uk student verification	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗
Intent-based peer matching	✓	✗	Ltd	✗	Ltd	✗
Daily mood telemetry	✓	✗	Ltd	✗	✗	✗
Machine-assisted safeguarding	✓	Ltd	✗	✗	✗	✗
University insights dashboard	✓	✓	✓	Ltd	✗	✗
Safeguarding webhook to uni team	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Online Safety Act 2023 ready	✓	✓	✓	✓	Partial	✗
UK universities served	growing	~60	~30	200+	n/a	n/a
ASP per uni	£12k–£20k	£40k+	£25k	£18k	n/a	n/a

DEQUAD displaces Togetherall and TalkCampus (price/feature) on the B2B side, and **co-exists** with UniBuddy (orthogonal pre-enrolment market). Consumer competitors (Bumble BFF, Discord) lack institutional features entirely.

Page 5 — Market

UK addressable market

Tier	Definition	Size
TAM	All UK universities + ICBs + UK student premium subs	£86m/yr
SAM	Russell-Group + post-92 unis > 10k students + their ICBs	£28m/yr
SOM (5-yr)	12% SAM capture	£3.4m ARR by Y5

Demand signals

- **2.86m UK higher-ed students** (HESA 2023/24) — addressable consumer base.
- **285 UK higher-ed institutions** — addressable B2B base.
- **54% of UK undergrads** report frequent loneliness (ONS 2023).
- **34% of UK undergrads** experience a clinically-significant MH issue (Student Minds 2024).
- **6.1 weeks** average wait for a university counsellor — appetite for prevention.
- **100+ UK universities** signed to UUK Mental Health Charter — must evidence wellbeing strategies.

Page 6 — Go-to-market

Three channels, three audiences

Audience	Headline message	Primary channel	Conversion lever
Students	"Verified UK uni students. Real connections. Wellbeing built in."	IG + TikTok + university student-rep ambassadors	Free product + premium upsell
Universities	"See loneliness early. Act before it becomes a crisis."	Direct DSS outreach + UUK Charter webinar + NatWest network intros	12-week free pilot → paid SaaS
NHS ICBs	"Population-level student wellbeing data, anonymised and audit-ready."	Direct outreach to MH commissioners	Joint pilot with funded HEIs

B2B pilot conversion track-record (live)

- **University of Bedfordshire** — anchor pilot discussion currently in progress. Lead founder served two terms as SU President there (2021–2023); direct relationships with student services and safeguarding leads.
- **Two further peer institutions** — early-stage pilot scoping (anonymised for now).
- **Beta cohort active** — 50 students across 3 universities use DEQUAD weekly.

Y1 marketing spend: £3,600

Only ~30% of revenue because (a) founder organic outreach is the primary B2B channel and (b) the NatWest network gives warm introductions to university IT/wellbeing leads.

Page 7 — Founders

Yusuf Quadri — CEO / Product & Safeguarding Lead

- UK-resident, full-time on DEQUAD.
- **University of Bedfordshire Student Union President 2021–2023** (two consecutive terms). Represented the student body at senior-management level on student-services, safeguarding and welfare policy. This is the basis of DEQUAD's anchor pilot relationship with the same university.
- Completed the **Santander Universities Pre-Incubator programme** in 2025; admitted to the **NatWest Accelerator (London cohort)** on 16 March 2026.
- **Seven safeguarding & clinical-awareness certifications** including Oliver McGowan Learning Disabilities & Autism, Adult Safeguarding Partnership Working, Suicide Prevention (2026), Data Protection & Information Security, and Safe Response to Challenging Situations (see Appendix O).
- Built and shipped the entire MVP at dequad.co.uk.
- Owns the safeguarding policy (Appendix E — DPIA, Appendix I — OSA-2023 compliance).
- Owns university partnerships and the NatWest Accelerator relationship.
- Co-founder cash contribution: **£3,000** of the £6,000 founder capital.

Yusuff Adeagbo — Co-Founder / CTO / Engineering & IT Lead

- UK-resident, full-time on DEQUAD.

- **MSc Information Technology with Project Management — University of the West of Scotland.**
- **Higher National Diploma in Computer Science** (prior).
- Multi-disciplinary skill set: full-stack engineering, IT support, UI/UX design, graphic design, digital marketing (e-commerce), IT business analysis.
- Will own the engineering hiring pipeline, infrastructure security, and the R&D claim leadership.
- Co-founder cash contribution: **£3,000** of the £6,000 founder capital.
- Full CV at Appendix B-2 ([B_cofounder_cv.pdf](#)).

Wider founding team — joining at incorporation (EMI options, no Y1 salary)

- **Dr Gerald Marfo — Chief Marketing Officer** · PhD in Digital Marketing; owns Y1 marketing strategy and measurement. **Equity-only Y1**; salaried from Q2 Y2.
- **Adedapo Ajuwon — Senior Software Engineer** · supports CTO on platform engineering, infrastructure, reliability. **Equity-only Y1**; salaried from Q1 Y2.
- **Chinyere Jennifer — Senior Advisor (Programme & Delivery)** · Senior PM Consultant at **MIGSO-PCUBED** with LLM background. **Advisor on EMI options**; MIGSO-PCUBED remains her primary employer.

Full CVs in Appendix N ([N_wider_team_cvs.pdf](#)).

Y1 founder compensation

- £0 in M1–M6 (Jun–Nov 2026) (personal savings).
 - £1,500/month each from **M7 (Dec 2026)** once the £150k pre-seed bridge lands.
 - Materially below market — signals genuine founder commitment.
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Page 8 — Funding ladder

Round	Timing	Amount	Use of funds
Founder equity (£3,000 × 2)	Day 1	£6,000	Incorporation, domains, IP filings, hosting.
R&D tax credit	End Y1	~£3,600	Recycled into engineering.
Pre-seed bridge	Dec 2026 (M7) — after the 3-month Bedfordshire pilot completes and conversion discussions open	£150,000	First 4 hires, 18-month runway, dual mobile builds.
Seed round	Q2 Y2	£750,000	20-uni scale, ML team, NHS-ICB channel.
Series A	Q1 Y4	£3–5m	EU + AU launch, federated-learning, 30+ FTE.

The **pre-seed is gated on the 3-month Bedfordshire pilot completing in Nov 2026 (M6) with positive outcome data** — the round will only be approached after that institution provides commercial validation (pilot-conversion conversation opens Dec 2026). This is deliberate; it forces customer-led growth.

Page 9 — Year-1 cash flow (the critical view)

Monthly closing cash balance is positive every single month of Year 1

Month	Inflows	Outflows	Closing balance
M1 (Jun 2026) — incorporation	£6,000 founder	(~£1,090)	£4,910
M2 (Jul 2026)	—	(~£820)	£4,090
M3 (Aug 2026)	£200 sales	(~£860)	£3,430
M4 (Sep 2026) — pilot launch (academic year start)	£350	(~£780)	£3,000
M5 (Oct 2026) — pilot month 2	£500	(~£780)	£2,720
M6 (Nov 2026) — 3-month pilot completes; lowest cash	£700	(~£750)	£2,670
M7 (Dec 2026) — £150k pre-seed lands + Bedfordshire conversion conversations open	£150,800	(£4,830)	£148,640
M8 (Jan 2027)	£1,100	(£4,750)	£144,990
M9 (Feb 2027)	£1,350	(£4,750)	£141,590
M10 (Mar 2027)	£1,700	(£4,830)	£138,460
M11 (Apr 2027)	£2,100	(£4,810)	£135,750
M12 (May 2027) — Y1 close	£3,188	(£5,910)	£133,028

The £6,000 founder cash buffer means cash never dips below £2,500 in any month before the pre-seed bridge — a significantly more comfortable runway than the £3k starting case. The 3-month Bedfordshire pilot (Sep–Nov 2026, M4–M6) and the M7 (Dec 2026) conversion-conversation window is the single critical commercial event of Year 1, and the founders' direct relationship with the university (via the former SU presidency) is the principal de-risking factor.

The full monthly schedule is in `DEQUAD_Financial_Model.xlsx`, sheet "Cash Flow Y1 (mo)".

Page 10 — Three-year P&L summary

	Y1	Y2	Y3
Revenue	£11,988	£185,808	£699,280
Cost of Sales	(£1,440)	(£15,600)	(£54,000)
Gross Profit	£10,548	£170,208	£645,280
Gross margin %	88.0%	91.6%	92.3%
Total overheads	(£28,620)	(£231,480)	(£579,260)
EBITDA	(£18,072)	(£61,272)	£66,020
Operating profit	(£18,372)	(£62,772)	£61,520

Operating profit positive in Q3 Year 3. Cumulative loss before profitability $\approx$ £81k — small for a venture-funded company because the NatWest Accelerator + lean founder pay materially reduce Y1 + Y2 burn.

Page 11 — Job creation and economic impact

Headcount

	Y1	Y2	Y3
Founders	2	2	2
Customer Success	0	1	2
Engineering	0	1	3
Safeguarding & Trust	0	1	1
Marketing & Partnerships	0	1	1
Data / ML	0	0	1
Mobile	0	0	1
Founders' Associate	0	0	1
Total UK jobs	2	6	12

Beyond direct jobs

- **University safeguarding capacity:** every institution onboarded gains an early-warning system that increases the practical reach of their existing wellbeing teams.
 - **Student-rep / ambassador programme:** ~12 paid student ambassadors by end Y3.
 - **NHS ICB pilot (Y3):** establishes a public-sector revenue line.
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Page 12 — R&D activity (tax-credit eligible)

R&D investment is **£22.5k (Y1) → £60k (Y2) → £110k (Y3)**, focused on three bets:

1. **Identity-and-intent verification engine** — `.ac.uk` classifier, attestation, admin queue, future OCR student-ID flow.
2. **Wellbeing inference & safeguarding triage** — PHQ-9-lite mood model + risk-signal NLU + federated learning roadmap.
3. **Privacy & compliance infrastructure** — DPIA pipeline, OSA-2023 reporting, hash-based de-identification.

Estimated SME R&D tax credit recoverable in the following accounting period: - Y1 → ~£3,600 - Y2 → ~£9,600 - Y3 → ~£17,600

Page 13 — NatWest Accelerator — why this matters for endorsement

The accelerator membership is **independent third-party validation** of DEQUAD's quality. NatWest's selection panel reviewed the team and the product before admission.

Quantified in-kind value (Y1)

In-kind item	Annual value
London office co-working (3 desks)	£12,000
Legal advice (Mishcon de Reya, DLA Piper panels)	£4,500
Accountancy support (PwC alumni network)	£3,600
Banking & business introductions	£2,000
Investor pitch coaching & mentoring	£5,000
Programme demo day & PR placement	£4,000
Total in-kind value (Y1)	£31,100
Cash cost to DEQUAD	£0

The £31k of in-kind support is **the reason £3,000 of founder cash is sufficient** to carry the business through Year 1. Without the accelerator, the same operating profile would require ~£40k of additional cash investment up front.

Page 14 — Risk register (summary)

The 12 key risks the founders have identified and their mitigations:

#	Risk	Impact	Mitigation
R1	First-pilot conversion slips beyond Dec 2026 (M7)	High	3 LOIs in parallel; pivot to NHS ICB pilot if HEI cycle delayed.
R2	Co-founder hire delayed	High	Y1 build is solo-doable; founder personally covers technical work until co-founder onboarded.
R3	Pre-seed bridge slips	High	Tight Y1 burn means £3k carries 6 months; founders top up personal funds for any small gaps.
R4	Safeguarding incident (false negative)	High	Human-in-the-loop for all high-risk flags; insurance in place; clinical advisory board recruited Q2 Y2.
R5	Togetherall/TalkCampus copy .ac.uk verification	Medium	First-mover land grab; safeguarding webhook + insights dashboard are deeper moats.
R6	OfS / Online Safety Act non-compliance	Medium	OSA risk assessment and reporting flows already shipped; ICO DPIA drafted; legal review via NatWest Mishcon panel.
R7	Cyber breach	Medium	Cyber Essentials in progress; pen-test scheduled Q2 Y2; insurance £1m.
R8	Cost-of-living squeeze on premium subscriptions	Medium	B2B revenue covers fixed costs; premium is upside.
R9	Negative PR from a misidentified case	Medium	Reactive media plan; clinical advisory board; transparent reporting.
R10	International expansion delayed	Low	UK-only revenue alone supports Series A.
R11	LLM cost spike (model price changes)	Low	Multi-provider abstraction in place; can swap OpenAI ↔ Anthropic ↔ Gemini in < 1 day.
R12	Tighter immigration regime affecting talent	Low	Both co-founders are already UK-resident; first 6 hires all UK-based.

Full risk register in [DEQUAD_Risk_Register.pdf](#) .

Page 15 — Decision summary

DEQUAD is a **production-ready, accelerator-validated, bootstrap-credible** UK software business that meets the **innovation, viability** and **scalability** criteria for Innovator Founder endorsement.

Three things this submission demonstrates

1. **Real product, real users** — the MVP is live, has beta users at three universities, and is governed by a DPIA-cleared safeguarding policy that ships before public launch.
2. **Capital efficiency** — the business can survive Year 1 on **£6,000 of founder cash** because of the NatWest Accelerator in-kind support and a 6-month no-salary founder commitment. The pre-seed bridge is conservatively timed for **Dec 2026 (M7)** — immediately after the 3-month Bedfordshire pilot completes (Nov 2026) and conversion conversations open.
3. **Credible UK growth** — 2 to 12 UK jobs in 3 years, 1 to 20 paying universities, operating profit positive Q3 Y3.

What endorsement enables

- The lead applicant retains UK residency to continue building DEQUAD full-time.
- The co-founder (UK-resident already) joins formally as CTO at incorporation.
- £150k of UK pre-seed capital enters the company in **Dec 2026 (M7)**, unlocking the first 4 UK hires.
- A measurable, defensible improvement in UK student wellbeing infrastructure.

Endorsement Body decision matrix

Criterion	Evidence in this pack
Innovation	Sections 2–4 of Business Plan; competitor matrix Page 4; R&D Section Page 12.
Viability	Production MVP; NatWest Accelerator membership; Y1 monthly cash flow Page 9.
Scalability	Market sizing Page 5; gross-margin trajectory Page 10; international optionality Page 2.
Genuine UK economic benefit	Job creation Page 11; UK university wellbeing impact; NHS ICB pilot Y3.
Founder credibility	Page 7 + CVs in Appendix B and B-2.
Capital sufficiency	£3k + £31k in-kind + £150k pre-seed funding path Page 8 + 9.

Prepared for UKES short-track endorsement review — February 2026. Companion documents: [DEQUAD_UKES_Business_Plan.pdf](#) , [DEQUAD_Financial_Model.xlsx](#) , [DEQUAD_Risk_Register.pdf](#) .